

ANDROID SMARTPHONE As Barcode/QR Scanner

MADHURAM MISHRA

We are all familiar with barcode scanners used in shopping malls, logistics and other places. These can scan only barcodes and are usually wired. Also, these can scan only one type of barcodes. Using Android smartphones, we can easily read barcodes, QR codes and some other codes for contacts sharing and website addresses seen in advertisements.

We can even use our Android smartphones as physical scanners and read scanned values on a connected PC. These smartphones use their cameras to scan the code and



Fig. 1: Android Barcode Reader and QR Scanner app icon

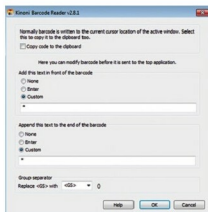


Fig. 2: Windows software/river



Fig. 3: Smartphone screen view

send the scanned data to the connected/paired Windows PC, using Bluetooth or Wi-Fi.

There are various free and paid apps available on Google Play Store for Android smartphones. In this article, Barcode Reader and QR Scanner app is used for demonstrating the use of Android phones as a barcode reader and a QR scanner.

The app should be installed in an Android device and software should be installed on the Windows PC in which we need to get the barcode data. The barcode in the PC will automatically appear at the cursor location once the initial setup is done.

This app has been tested with Moto G (2nd generation) mobile

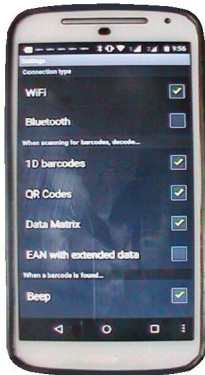


Fig. 4: Moto G (2nd generation) screenshot

(Xiaomi Redmi 1S smartphone was used by author) and Windows 7 laptop using Wi-Fi network. If you are using Wi-Fi mode, then both the smartphone and PC must be connected to the same Wi-Fi network.

Setup and connection to detect barcode

Set up your wireless network. Exact setup details will depend on your Windows version and phone model. Please check Microsoft and phone manufacturer support on how to connect to a wireless network, if needed.

Install Kinoni Barcode Reader app Barcode Reader and QR Scanner (Fig. 1) on your phone from Google Play Store.

Download and install Kinoni Barcode Reader Windows drivers (Fig. 2) to your PC.

Start Kinoni Barcode Reader app on your phone.

Wait for a few seconds while your phone and PC automatically connect via Wi-Fi. After a connection is established, you will see a camera viewfinder image on your phone screen and a pop-up on the PC system tray. If connection fails, please check troubleshooting section below.

Start the PC application, in which you can send barcodes. For testing purposes, you may use Notepad application. Make sure focus is on the window you want to send barcodes to (Fig. 3).

Troubleshooting

If you experience connectivity problems using Kinoni Barcode Reader, check for the following typical issues: